Q&A Document		
January 21, 2025		
Agenda Item	**Question**	**Answer**
Draft 2025-26 School Calendar	What are the plans to communicate soft start change (and soft start period) for Kinder families? I'd be interested in how families would feel about the additional day of soft start - I think it's really hard to get childcare that week and it often comes as a somewhat late surprise. Has staff considered the impact on working families and can they explain more about that?	Next year will be our 4th year of offering a four-day Ramp Up to support Kindergarten transition. This period of time provides every family with a 1:1 conversation with their Kindergarten teacher and every student with a practice Kindergarten day in a small group setting. The decision to move to this practice came out of wide stakeholder engagement and a deep dive into the research on kindergarten transitions via our district P-3 Advisory Council. Prior to the origin of PPS Kindergarten Ramp Up, Kindergarteners still started after their 1st-12th grade peers--but, these non-school days supported pre-assessment of students versus connective activities for students and families. While we understand that this can be a hard week for families to arrange child care, we also believe strongly in the need to support our incoming Kindergarten students and families as they transition into new learning environments. Information about the Ramp Up is always available on both our district Kindergarten website and school Kindergarten websites--and will be updated with accurate dates once the 2025-26 calendar is approved by the Board.